

friends INDEED

* Anadha Vidyarthi Griha

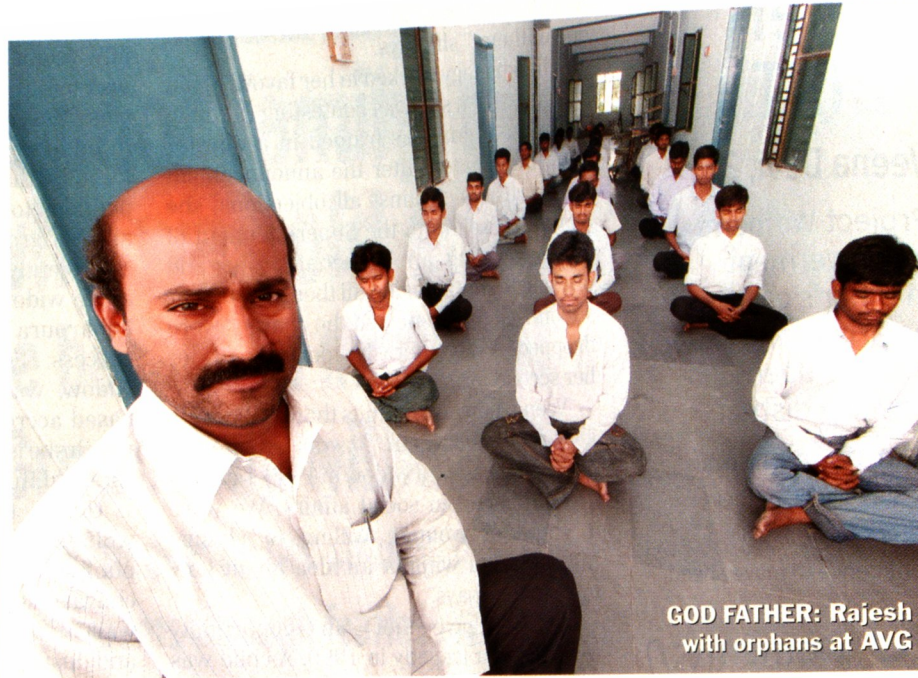
Project Transforming
an orphanage into a
launchpad

Can-do Motto

Humanity inspires us to help
educate the willing, over-
coming hunger and poverty

There are 14.3 crore
orphans in the world, with

2.6
crore
in India



GOD FATHER: Rajesh
with orphans at AVG

It's a commune with a difference. Its occupants are the orphaned who dream big and aspire higher. But they don't wait for a saviour. They do everything themselves, from raising funds to managing the oldest orphanage in Hyderabad. Among those who have passed through its portals are a former governor (B. Satyanarayana Reddy) and a

former Union petroleum minister (B.R. Shankaranand). There are many others as well who have moved on to senior positions at ICGI, IBM and Wipro, the shiny symbols of a successful India.

AVG's ethos is an eclectic mix of individual initiatives and collective responsibility compounded by a spartan life. Besides food and accommodation, AVG, founded in 1919, provides college fees, bus fare, medical expenses, books and stationery and pocket money. Coaching for professional courses is arranged with leading training academies which accommodate the indigent aspirants

from AVG free of cost. All purchase accounting and even the audit is done by the inhabitants.

AVG has no warden or caretaker, not even a single salaried employee. The "income" comes from donations ranging from Rs 2 to Rs 500 per month. "Our mission and vision is to make the boys confident to face the challenges of life. It is not the money but the heart that keeps AVG alive even after 80 years," says treasurer G. Ram Reddy who stayed here for five years while studying veterinary science in the '60s and retired as an assistant director in the department of animal husbandry. "The only bondage is a spirit of living together with discipline, affection and friendliness with an unwritten understanding of one for all and all for one," says AVG general secretary M. Rajesh. For the orphans here, India is shining.

by Amarnath K. Menon

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The only bondage is that of living together with affection and understanding.

M. RAJESH, AVG general secretary

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